Template

Conducting a brainstorm

Executing a brainstorm isn't unique; holding a productive brainstorm is. Great brainstorms are ones that set the stage for fresh and generative thinking through simple guidelines and an open and collaborative environment. Use this when you're just kicking-off a new project and want to hit the ground running with big ideas that will move your team forward.

- **15 minutes** to prepare
- **30-60 minutes** to collaborate
- **3-8 people** recommended

Share template feedback

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

15 minutes

A **Choose your best "How Might We" Questions**
Create 5 HMW statements before the activity to propose them to the team.

B **Set the stage for creativity and inclusivity**
Go over the brainstorming rules and keep them in front of your team while brainstorming to encourage collaboration, optimism, and creativity.

1. **Encourage wild ideas** (If none of the ideas sound a bit ridiculous, then you are filtering yourself too much.)
2. **Defer judgement** (This can be as direct as harsh words or as subtle as a condescending tone or talking over one another.)
3. **Build on the ideas of others** ("I want to build on that idea" or the use of "yes, and...")
4. **Stay focused on the topic at hand**
5. **Have one conversation at a time**
6. **Be visual** (Draw and/or upload to show ideas, whenever possible.)
7. **Go for quantity**

C **Interested in learning more?**
Check out the Meta Think Kit website for additional tools and resources to help your team collaborate, innovate and move ideas forward with confidence.

Open the website

1 Choose your best "How Might We" Questions

Share the top 5 brainstorm questions that you created and let the group determine where to begin by selecting one question to move forward with based on what seems to be the most promising for idea generation in the areas you are trying to impact.

10 minutes

QUESTION
How the cracks in tracks can be detected ?

QUESTION
How the break system of the train can be improved ?

QUESTION
How the loss of signals during the motion of train can be resolved ?

QUESTION
What are the modern ways to enhance the power system in train ?

QUESTION
How to improvise the train parts fault detection system ?

2 Brainstorm solo

Have each participant begin in the "solo brainstorm space" by silently brainstorming ideas and placing them into the template. This "silent-storming" avoids group-think and creates an inclusive environment for introverts and extroverts alike. Set a time limit. Encourage people to go for quantity.

10 minutes

MONICA . S

- Population management
- Train track replacement
- Railway Accidents
- Attack on Railways
- Problem of Replacement
- Ticket payment
- Inadequate Investment
- Transport traffic
- Hygeine management

SWATHI . S

- Late running of train
- Lack of security arrangements
- Lack of cleanlinees
- Theft and dacoities
- Reservation of seats
- Monopoly
- Booking formalities
- Unsuitable for small distance and small goods
- Huge capital outlay

SINDU MITHRA M.K.

- Extending of train network
- Not suitable for rural
- Stranded projects
- Lack of man power in railways
- Unnecessary use of emergency chain
- Management issues
- Energy consumption
- Finances and accounting
- Ticketless travelling

NIVEDHITHA . P

- Old Track and Poor State of Rolling Stock
- Operating efficiency
- Lack of Modern Management
- General inefficiency
- Issues with double line laying
- Lacks repair and maintenance of tracks and bridges
- Rough terrain
- Weather condition
- Under utilized capacity

Brainstorm as a group

3 Brainstorm as a group

Have everyone move their ideas into the "group sharing space" within the template and have the team silently read through them. As a team, sort and group them by thematic topics or similarities. Discuss and answer any questions that arise. Encourage "Yes, and..." and build on the ideas of other people along the way.

15 minutes

History	Source	Applications	Drawbacks
1853-1869: Launching passenger rail services	Power supply	Transportaton of goods	Huge capital outlay
1901-1925: Moves towards centralisation	Passengers	Travelling for short and long distance	Centralized administration
1925-1946: Electrification and hard times	Freight	Public transport at afordable cost .	
1980-2000: Technology and phasing out steam	Track for train		
Recently Metro rail			

4 Decide your focus

Give each person two icons to vote which idea should your team focus on.

5 minutes

MONICA .S

SWATHI . S

SINDU MITHRA M.K.

NIVEDHITHA . P

Quick add-ons

After you collaborate

A **Cluster related ideas**
A brainstorm like this typically results in a handful of promising ideas that you can carry forward and act upon.

B **Vote on the most promising ideas**

Keep moving forward

2x2 Prioritization matrix
Build shared understanding and make collective decisions for moving ideas forward.
Open the template

Storyboarding
Show existing and/or future consumer experiences through the act of sketching.
Open the template

Pre-mortem
Harness the collective experience and wisdom of the team, before the project even starts.
Open the template

Share template feedback